10/10 Habits for Shirt-Off Confidence Before the New Year

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 02, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/-ahAM8RMlE8 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, a trainer with 27+ years of experience, presents habits to get fit before the New Year — emphasizing daily walking, calorie/macro tracking, a simple calorie formula, and high protein intake to preserve muscle during a deficit.

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🚀 Don't Wait for New Year's 0:00

- Many people are waiting for January 1st to start their fitness goals — Carter argues this is a mistake
  - Waiting means continuing to gain fat in the meantime, which creates even more work to do later
  - Following these habits now means entering 2027 with momentum already built
  - Goal: avoid the typical pattern of quitting by Valentine's Day (as happened the prior year)

🚶 Habit 1: Walk 20,000 Steps Every Day 0:25

- Target: **20,000 steps per day**
- Carter draws on 27+ years of training experience and coaching thousands of clients
  - Claims that people who follow this habit consistently get into great shape
- Directly addresses the "I don't have time" excuse
  - States bluntly: the excuse is why people remain overweight and keep searching for weight-loss videos online
  - Notes that the algorithm serves weight-loss content to people who make excuses rather than take action

📱 Habit 2: Track Your Calories and Macros 0:35

- Track every calorie and every macro — Carter calls this non-negotiable and straightforward
  - "It's just entering some numbers into your phone"
- Tools Carter personally uses and recommends:
  - **Claude** (AI) — Carter's own method for tracking calories and macros
  - **ChatGPT** — an alternative AI option viewers can use
  - Taking a photo of food is sometimes enough input for the AI to estimate macros
- Key message: stop being intimidated by tracking; it is simple and accessible

🔢 Habit 3: Use the Bodyweight × 10 Calorie Formula 0:47

- Simple formula to find your daily calorie target for getting lean:
  - Take your bodyweight in **pounds**
  - Multiply by **10**
  - The result = daily calorie intake target
- Carter anticipates pushback that this creates "too large a calorie deficit" and dismisses it firmly
  - Cites his track record of training thousands of people as the basis for confidence in this number

🥩 Habit 4: Eat 1 Gram of Protein per Pound of Bodyweight 1:10

- Target: **1 gram of protein per pound of bodyweight per day**
- Purpose: preserve muscle mass while in a calorie deficit so you don't look skinny or weak
- Addresses conflicting advice online suggesting 0.7–0.8 g/lb is sufficient
  - Carter argues those studies measured protein needed to *build* muscle, not to *retain* muscle in a deficit
  - Retaining muscle during a cut requires more protein than building muscle in a surplus context
- Thermogenic advantage of protein:
  - Protein has the highest thermic effect of food (TEF) of all macronutrients
  - **20–30% of protein calories** are burned during digestion
  - That is roughly **2× the TEF of carbohydrates** and approximately **10× the TEF of fat**
  - This means protein's net caloric impact is significantly lower than its label calories suggest

> Protein's thermic effect means 20–30% of its calories are burned just digesting it — making it far more fat-loss-friendly than carbs or fat on a gram-for-gram basis.